century, first towards South East Asia and Africa and later towards the US, Europe and West Asia.

Along with a greater transnational presence, the social base of entrepreneurship in India has also been widening. Community-based migration appears to be an important route towards success for the latecomers. The migration of Gounders around the cotton textile hub of Tiruppur or the migration of Saurashtra Patels towards the diamond hub of Surat in the late 20th century have been short-distance migrations that led to considerably upward mobility as workers became entrepreneurs. The agricultural landowning caste of coastal Andhra Pradesh—the Kammas—used agricultural wealth to move to nearby towns and Hyderabad, and eventually the US, as doctors and engineers to form a transnational community network with substantial capital.[91]

With the emergence of management education, many people found a new stepping stone towards becoming rich, as managers could rise to become directors or even owners of firms. Migration for education and professional reasons was not necessarily linked to caste groups per se, but those who invested first in education had a substantial edge. Here, the Brahmins, historically associated with the education sectors were natural first movers and stormed the trading–community bastion of corporate India. In 2010, as per one study, 45 per cent of the directors of India's 1000 largest companies were Brahmins, a figure close to that of the traditional trading castes.[92] That is, over 90 per cent of the leading corporate directors were Brahmins or Banias who formed less than 10 per cent of the Indian population. Historical migration, networks and the ability to exploit these to gain information about new jobs and business opportunities are important factors that explain this dominance. Conversely, relatively lower long-term spatial mobility and smaller information sets have reduced the chances of acquiring capital among many social groups, including the Dalits and Adivasis, and also stunted the development of their diasporas.